

Unit 2

The Solar system and the Earth

Chapter Outline

2.1 Introduction
2.2 Theories of the Earth's origin
2.3 Modern theories of the origin of the Universe
2.4 Star and Constellations
2.5 The Solar system
2.6 The Sun
2.7 The Planets
2.8 Dwarf Planets
2.9 Satellites
2.10 Asteroids
2.11 Comets
2.12 Meteors
2.13 Shape and size of the Earth
2.14 Motions of the earth
2.15 Seasons
2.16 Time Zones of the World

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Learning Objectives:

- *To know more about the universe, stars, planets and others.*
- *Understand theories of the origin of the Universe.*
- *Explain the position of the planets in the solar system.*
- *Describe the cause and effect of the motions of the earth.*

2.1 Introduction

Have you ever relaxed lying on the terrace of a building or in the front yard at a cloudless night? If yes, could you watch the night sky filled with glittering stars which appear to be growing in numbers? These glittering stars, which we see, are a part of the universe. Let us now discuss in detail about the Universe, stars, planets and other objects. **The Universe** is a vast endless space which includes galaxies, stars, planets and other forms of matter and energy in it.

2.2 Theories of the Earth's origin

There are many theories supporting the origin of the earth. One of the earlier and popular arguments of the earth's origin was by a German professor Immanuel Kant. Mathematician Laplace revised it in 1796. It was known as Nebular Hypothesis. It considered that planets were formed out of a cloud of material

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